

GK Capsule — General Knowledge for Paper 1

Exam: NPSC Combined Technical Services Examination (CTSE) 2026

Paper: General English & General Knowledge (Combined) — **100 marks, 3 hours**

Date: 26 September 2026, 09:00–12:00 (your FIRST exam of the whole series)

This file covers: the GK half — **50 of the 100 marks.**

Companion files: [01_GENERAL_PAPER_PLAYBOOK.md](#) (how to sit the paper) and [02_ESSAY_BANK.md](#) (the English half). This file is the *content*; the playbook is the *technique*. Read the playbook for timing; study this for facts.

0. Why this matters (read this before anything else)

Straight from [Materials/_Shared/OFFICIAL_SYLLABUS.md](#) §1, the GK block is:

"General knowledge comprising of current events, general science, mental ability, Indian history, Indian polity, Indian economy, Geography with combination of objective type and short descriptive answers — 50 Marks."

Three facts about this block decide how you should study it:

1. **GK is the only half of the paper where marks are binary.** A mediocre essay still scores 9–11/20. In GK you either know the capital of Manipur or you do not. So GK is where *study* pays — unlike English, where *practice* pays. Every hour here converts almost linearly into marks.
2. **You have a structural home-ground advantage almost no other candidate has: you are a Naga sitting a Nagaland state exam.** The single highest-yield, least-contested block in the entire GK syllabus is **Nagaland & North-East GK plus Article 371A**. Most candidates under-prepare it because no national guidebook covers it. You can own it completely. **Sections 2 and 3 of this file are the most important pages you will study for 26 September.** Treat them as compulsory, not optional.
3. **"Combination of objective type and short descriptive answers"** means GK is split — a block of 1-mark/2-mark objective items *plus* several 3–5 mark short-answer questions. So you must know facts *cold* (for objective) **and** be able to write a tidy 60–120 word structured answer (for short descriptive). Where a topic is a likely short-answer, this file gives you the skeleton.

⚠ **Accuracy note on this file.** Fixed constitutional and historical facts (article numbers, dates of statehood, amendment numbers) are stable and given plainly. Anything that *changes over time* — the current number of districts, current office-holders, latest scheme outlays, populations — is marked ⚠ **verify** because it may have moved since this file was written. **Never write a "⚠ verify" number into the exam unless you have re-checked it.** For those, use the qualitative phrasing the playbook teaches ("a large share of", "the majority of").

Tick-box checklist — what "GK-ready" means

Tick a box only when you can produce the fact from memory *and*, for the deeper topics, write a 5-mark answer.

Polity

- [] Preamble — keywords and what each means
- [] Fundamental Rights (Art. 12–35) — the six, with key articles
- [] Fundamental Duties (Art. 51A) — origin and the eleven

- [] DPSP (Art. 36–51) — nature and key articles
- [] Union executive: President, VP, PM, Council of Ministers
- [] Parliament: Lok Sabha vs Rajya Sabha; how a bill becomes law
- [] Judiciary: Supreme Court, High Courts, judicial review
- [] Federal structure; three Lists (Union/State/Concurrent)
- [] Emergency provisions (Art. 352, 356, 360)
- [] Panchayati Raj (73rd) and Municipalities (74th) — **and how 371A interacts**
- [] Constitutional bodies: EC, UPSC, CAG, Finance Commission, AG
- [] Key amendments (1, 42, 44, 61, 73/74, 101)
- [] ★ **Article 371A — cold, every clause (Section 2). Highest single yield.**

Nagaland & North-East (Section 3) — the compulsory block

- [] Statehood path: NNC → 16-Point Agreement → 1 Dec 1963
- [] Tribes, festivals (tribe + month), languages, Nagamese
- [] Geography: Saramati, Dzūkou, rivers, Intanki, jhum
- [] State symbols, capital, districts, administrative structure
- [] Basics of the other seven NE states (capital + one fact each)

History

- [] Ancient (IVC, Vedic, Mauryas, Guptas) — headline facts
- [] Medieval (Delhi Sultanate, Mughals) — headline facts
- [] Modern + **freedom-struggle timeline 1857 → 1947 cold**
- [] Naga/NE history where relevant

Economy

- [] GDP/GNP/NNP; inflation; fiscal vs monetary policy
- [] Budget, RBI, NITI Aayog, GST; major schemes

Geography

- [] India physical, climate, rivers, soils, resources
- [] Nagaland geography (cross-linked to Section 3)

General Science

- [] Physics: measurement, motion, light, sound, electricity
- [] Chemistry: atomic structure, acids/bases, everyday chemistry
- [] Biology: human body, nutrition/vitamins, diseases, classification, ecology

Mental Ability (Section 8) — must be fast

- [] Series, coding, blood relations, direction, syllogism, analogy
- [] Ratio, %, profit/loss, time & work, time & distance, averages
- [] SI/CI, probability, clocks, calendars

Current Affairs (Section 9)

- [] Working the "what to look up" checklist Sept 2025 → Sept 2026 weekly

SECTION 1 — INDIAN POLITY

Polity is the most *reliable* scorer in GK: the facts are fixed, they do not change year to year, and the questions are standard. Master this section and you bank a predictable block of marks.

1.1 The Constitution — the frame

Intuition first. A constitution is just the rulebook that says who may do what, and what the state may never do to you. India's is the longest written constitution in the world because it tries to write *everything* down rather than leave it to convention.

Fact	Value

Constituent Assembly formed	1946 (under the Cabinet Mission Plan)
Chairman, Drafting Committee	Dr. B. R. Ambedkar
President of the Constituent Assembly	Dr. Rajendra Prasad
Adopted	26 November 1949 (Constitution Day / <i>Samvidhan Divas</i>)
Came into force	26 January 1950 (Republic Day)
Time taken	2 years, 11 months, 18 days
Borrowed features	Parliamentary system & rule of law — UK; Fundamental Rights & judicial review — USA; DPSP — Ireland; Emergency — Germany; Concurrent List & trade/commerce — Australia; Fundamental Duties & planning — USSR; amendment procedure — South Africa

MCQ trap: the Constitution was *adopted* on 26 Nov 1949 but *came into force* on 26 Jan 1950. Questions deliberately swap these two dates.

1.2 The Preamble

"WE, THE PEOPLE OF INDIA, having solemnly resolved to constitute India into a SOVEREIGN SOCIALIST SECULAR DEMOCRATIC REPUBLIC and to secure to all its citizens: JUSTICE — social, economic and political; LIBERTY of thought, expression, belief, faith and worship; EQUALITY of status and of opportunity; and to promote among them all FRATERNITY assuring the dignity of the individual and the unity and integrity of the Nation..."

Point	Detail
Words added by the 42nd Amendment (1976)	SOCIALIST, SECULAR, and INTEGRITY
"Soul of the Constitution" / "Identity card of the Constitution"	the Preamble (N. A. Palkhivala)
Source of the Preamble's ideals	the Objectives Resolution moved by Nehru
Is the Preamble part of the Constitution?	Yes (<i>Kesavananda Bharati</i> , 1973) and it can be amended, but not its basic structure (<i>S. R. Bose / Berubari</i> clarified it is a key to interpretation)

Memory hook — the four ideals in order: **J-L-E-F** = Justice, Liberty, Equality, Fraternity. **Justice comes first, Fraternity last.**

1.3 Fundamental Rights (Part III, Articles 12–35)

Intuition. These are the promises the state makes to *you* that a court can enforce. If the state breaks one, you can go straight to the Supreme Court (Art. 32) — which Ambedkar called "**the heart and soul of the Constitution.**"

#	Right	Articles	Core content
1	Right to Equality	14–18	Equality before law (14); no discrimination on religion/race/caste/sex/birth (15); equal opportunity in public employment (16); abolition of untouchability (17); abolition of titles (18)

2	Right to Freedom	19–22	Six freedoms — speech, assembly, association, movement, residence, profession (19); protection re conviction (20); protection of life & personal liberty (21) ; right to education 6–14 yrs (21A); protection against arrest (22)
3	Right against Exploitation	23–24	Ban on human trafficking & forced labour (23); ban on child labour under 14 in hazardous work (24)
4	Right to Freedom of Religion	25–28	Freedom of conscience & practice (25); manage religious affairs (26); no tax for religion (27); no religious instruction in wholly state-funded schools (28)
5	Cultural & Educational Rights	29–30	Protection of minorities' language/script/culture (29); minorities' right to run educational institutions (30)
6	Right to Constitutional Remedies	32	Right to move the SC for enforcement — the "heart and soul"

The five writs (under Art. 32 / 226):

Writ	Literal meaning	Used to...
Habeas Corpus	"to have the body"	Produce a detained person; check unlawful detention
Mandamus	"we command"	Order a public official to do their duty
Prohibition	—	Stop a lower court exceeding its jurisdiction (before)
Certiorari	"to be certified"	Quash a lower court's order (after)
Quo Warranto	"by what authority"	Question a person's right to hold a public office

MCQ traps:

- Right to Property was **removed** as a Fundamental Right by the **44th Amendment (1978)**; it is now a *legal* right under **Art. 300A**. Very frequently asked.
- Art. 20 and 21 **cannot be suspended even during a National Emergency** (44th Amdt).

1.4 Directive Principles of State Policy (Part IV, Articles 36–51)

Intuition. If Fundamental Rights are enforceable promises, DPSPs are *goals* — the state *should* aim for them but you cannot sue if it doesn't. They are "instructions to the government" for building a welfare state.

Feature	Fundamental Rights	DPSP
Enforceable in court?	Yes	No (Art. 37)
Nature	Political democracy	Social & economic democracy
Borrowed from	USA	Ireland
Aim	Restrain the state	Direct the state

Key DPSPs to remember: Art. 39A (equal justice, free legal aid), 40 (organise **village panchayats**), 44 (**Uniform Civil Code**), 45 (early childhood care), 47 (nutrition, ban intoxicants), 48A (protect environment & wildlife), 50 (separate judiciary from executive), 51 (promote international peace).

1.5 Fundamental Duties (Article 51A, Part IVA)

- Added by the **42nd Amendment (1976)** on the recommendation of the **Swaran Singh**

Committee, inspired by the **USSR** constitution.

- Originally **ten**; the **86th Amendment (2002)** added the **eleventh** (a parent/guardian to provide education to a child aged 6–14).
- **Not enforceable** by courts (like DPSPs).

Sample duties: abide by the Constitution; cherish the freedom struggle's ideals; protect sovereignty & integrity; defend the country; promote harmony; preserve composite culture; **protect the natural environment**; develop scientific temper; safeguard public property; strive for excellence.

1.6 The Union Executive

President (Art. 52–62):

Point	Detail
Nature	Constitutional (nominal) head; real power with Council of Ministers
Election	Indirect — by an electoral college of elected MPs + elected MLAs, by single transferable vote / proportional representation
Term	5 years; eligible for re-election
Qualification	Citizen, 35+, qualified for Lok Sabha membership
Removal	Impeachment for "violation of the Constitution" (Art. 61)
Key powers	Executive, legislative (assent to bills, ordinances Art. 123), judicial (pardon Art. 72), emergency, military

Prime Minister & Council of Ministers (Art. 74–75): The PM is appointed by the President (leader of the majority in Lok Sabha). Art. 74 — Council of Ministers headed by PM to **aid and advise** the President (advice is **binding**, 42nd/44th Amdt). The Council is **collectively responsible to the Lok Sabha** (Art. 75).

Vice-President (Art. 63–71): ex-officio Chairman of the **Rajya Sabha**; elected by both Houses (electoral college of MPs only).

1.7 Parliament

Intuition. Two Houses: Lok Sabha is "the people's house" (directly elected, powerful on money); Rajya Sabha is "the states' house" (permanent, represents states).

Feature	Lok Sabha (House of the People)	Rajya Sabha (Council of States)
Max strength	552 (530 states + 20 UTs) △ verify current	250 (238 elected + 12 nominated)
Elected by	People directly	State legislatures (STV)
Term	5 years (dissolvable)	Permanent — 1/3 retire every 2 yrs
Presiding officer	Speaker	Vice-President (Chairman)
Money bills	Originate only here (Art. 110)	Can only recommend; must return in 14 days
No-confidence motion	Only here	Cannot

How a bill becomes law: Introduction → First reading → Second reading (clause-by-clause) → Third reading → other House repeats → **President's assent** (Art. 111).

A **Money Bill** needs the President's prior recommendation and starts only in Lok Sabha.

A deadlock on an *ordinary* bill is resolved by a **joint sitting (Art. 108)**, presided

over by the **Speaker**.

1.8 The Judiciary

- **Supreme Court (Art. 124)**: integrated single judiciary; **judicial review** (can strike down laws violating the Constitution); guardian of Fundamental Rights.
- **Judges**: appointed by the President; retire at **65 (SC)** / **62 (HC)**.
- **Basic Structure Doctrine** — *Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973)*: Parliament can amend any part of the Constitution **but cannot alter its "basic structure"** (supremacy of the Constitution, secularism, separation of powers, federalism, judicial review, rule of law). A landmark, very high-yield.

1.9 Federal structure & the three Lists (7th Schedule)

List	Who legislates	Examples
Union List	Parliament only	Defence, foreign affairs, railways, currency, atomic energy
State List	State legislatures	Police, public health, agriculture, local government
Concurrent List	Both (Union prevails on conflict)	Education, forests, marriage, criminal law

Residuary powers (anything not listed) belong to the **Union** (Art. 248).

1.10 Emergency provisions

Type	Article	Ground	Effect
National Emergency	352	War, external aggression, or armed rebellion	Centre gains sweeping power; FRs (except 20, 21) may be suspended
State (President's Rule)	356	Failure of constitutional machinery in a state	State comes under Centre
Financial Emergency	360	Threat to India's financial stability	Never yet imposed

MCQ trap: the 44th Amendment (1978) changed the 352 ground from "internal disturbance" to "**armed rebellion**" to prevent misuse (as in 1975).

1.11 Panchayati Raj & local government — with the Nagaland twist

- **73rd Amendment (1992)** — rural local government (Panchayati Raj), **Part IX, Art. 243–243O**, 11th Schedule (29 subjects). Three tiers: Gram Panchayat → Panchayat Samiti (block) → Zilla Parishad (district).
- **74th Amendment (1992)** — urban local bodies (Municipalities), Part IXA, 12th Schedule (18 subjects).
- ★ **Nagaland link (exam gold)**: By **Article 243M, Part IX (Panchayati Raj)** does **NOT apply to Nagaland, Meghalaya and Mizoram** and to the Scheduled/Tribal areas. Nagaland instead runs governance through its own **traditional Village Councils and Village Development Boards (VDBs)**, and its distinctive **Communitisation of Public Institutions and Services Act, 2002** — a genuinely Nagaland-specific innovation that hands local communities charge of schools, health centres and utilities. **This connects Section 1 to Section 2/3 and is a natural short-answer question.**

1.12 Constitutional & other key bodies

Body	Article	Role
Election Commission	324	Conducts elections; a multi-member body (CEC + ECs)
UPSC	315	Recruits for central services
CAG	148	Audits government accounts; "guardian of the public purse"
Finance Commission	280	Recommends Centre–State tax sharing (every 5 yrs)
Attorney General	76	Chief legal adviser to the Government of India
NITI Aayog	(not constitutional; not statutory)	Policy think-tank, replaced Planning Commission (2015)

MCQ trap: NITI Aayog and the Planning Commission are **executive** bodies (set up by resolution), **not** constitutional bodies. The Finance Commission **is** constitutional.

1.13 Landmark amendments to memorise

Amendment	Year	What it did
1st	1951	Added the 9th Schedule (protect land-reform laws from review)
42nd ("Mini-Constitution")	1976	Added <i>Socialist, Secular, Integrity</i> to Preamble; Fundamental Duties; made DPSP superior in parts
44th	1978	Removed Right to Property from FRs (→ Art. 300A); "armed rebellion" in Art. 352; protected Art. 20 & 21
52nd	1985	Anti-defection law (10th Schedule)
61st	1989	Voting age 21 → 18
73rd / 74th	1992	Panchayati Raj / Municipalities
86th	2002	Right to Education (Art. 21A); 11th Fundamental Duty
101st	2016	Goods and Services Tax (GST)

Polity — likely exam questions

- [5] Explain Article 371A and why it is special to Nagaland. (See Section 2.)
- [5] Distinguish between Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles of State Policy.
- [5] What are the five types of writs? Explain any two.
- [10] Describe the emergency provisions of the Indian Constitution.
- [10] Explain the composition and powers of the Rajya Sabha vs the Lok Sabha.
- [5] Why does Part IX (Panchayati Raj) not apply to Nagaland, and what governs local administration there instead?

Polity — MCQ traps (with answers)

Ten quick MCQ-style checks — click for answers

1. Constitution came into **force** on? → **26 January 1950** 2. Words added by the 42nd Amendment to the Preamble? → **Socialist, Secular, Integrity** 3. "Heart and soul of the Constitution" (Ambedkar)? → **Article 32** (Right to Constitutional Remedies) 4. Right to Property is now under which article? → **Article**

300A** (a legal right) 5. Which rights cannot be suspended in a National Emergency? → **Articles 20 and 21** 6. DPSP is borrowed from? → **Ireland** 7. Money Bill can be introduced only in? → **Lok Sabha** 8. Basic Structure Doctrine came from which case? → **Kesavananda Bharati (1973)** 9. Fundamental Duties were added on the recommendation of? → **Swaran Singh Committee** 10. GST was introduced by which amendment? → **101st Amendment (2016)**

SECTION 2 — ★ ARTICLE 371A: NAGALAND'S SPECIAL PROVISIONS

This is the single highest-yield item in the entire GK syllabus for you. It is Nagaland-specific, it is constitutional (so the facts are fixed and cannot be argued), and a Nagaland state examiner is *very* likely to set it. Learn every clause. It is equally usable as an objective answer, a 5-mark short answer, and a paragraph in almost any essay on the North-East.

2.1 The intuition — why 371A exists at all

When Nagaland became a state in 1963, the Nagas had just come out of a long conflict with the Indian state over identity and autonomy. Article 371A was the constitutional promise that **statehood would not mean the erasure of Naga customary law, land ownership and social practice**. In plain terms: *Parliament's ordinary laws will not automatically override Naga tradition — the Nagaland Assembly gets to decide whether they apply*. It is a shield for Naga customary autonomy inside the Indian Union.

2.2 The facts

Point	Detail
Inserted by	13th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1962
Effective	1 December 1963 (the day Nagaland became a state)
Part of the Constitution	Part XXI (temporary, transitional and special provisions)

2.3 The four protected subjects (learn these as a list)

Under Art. 371A(1)(a), **no Act of Parliament shall apply to Nagaland** in respect of the following **unless the Nagaland Legislative Assembly so decides by a resolution**:

- 1. Religious or social practices of the Nagas**
- 2. Naga customary law and procedure**
- 3. Administration of civil and criminal justice** involving decisions according to Naga customary law
- 4. Ownership and transfer of land and its resources**

Memory hook: "R-C-J-L" — Religious/social practice, Customary law, Justice by customary law, Land & resources.

★ The **land and resources** clause is the most consequential and the most examined: it is why land in Nagaland is largely owned by individuals, clans and villages rather than the state, and it shapes debates over oil, minerals and land acquisition.

2.4 The other clauses

Clause	Provision
371A(1)(b)	Special responsibility of the Governor for law and order in Nagaland so long as internal disturbances continue (historically re: the Naga Hills–Tuensang Area); the Governor acts in his individual judgement on this.
371A(2)	Provision for a Regional Council for the Tuensang district and special arrangements for its administration during a transitional period.
371A(1)(d)	Governor's special responsibility regarding the equitable allocation of money provided by the Centre between Tuensang and the rest of the state (transitional).

2.5 How to use it in the exam

- **Objective:** "Article 371A relates to which state?" → **Nagaland**. "Which amendment inserted it?" → **13th (1962)**.
- **5-mark short answer skeleton:** (1) one-line definition — special constitutional provision for Nagaland; (2) inserted by 13th Amendment, effective 1 Dec 1963; (3) the four protected subjects (R-C-J-L); (4) the Assembly-resolution safeguard; (5) one line on significance — protects Naga customary law, land and identity; basis of Nagaland's distinct land tenure.
- **Essay hook:** on any North-East topic — governance, land, resources, identity, federalism — one sentence on Art. 371A localises your argument and scores.

MCQ traps:

- 371A relates to **Nagaland**; do not confuse with **371G (Mizoram)**, **371F (Sikkim)**, **371B (Assam)**, **371C (Manipur)**, **371H (Arunachal Pradesh)**.
- It was inserted by the **13th** Amendment, not the State of Nagaland Act.

SECTION 3 — ★ NAGALAND & THE NORTH-EAST (GO DEEP)

Your least-contested, highest-yield block. A national candidate cannot compete with a Naga on this. Learn it thoroughly; expect several objective items and at least one short-answer question.

3.1 The road to statehood — the timeline

Intuition. The Naga political movement predates Indian independence. The path to statehood ran through decades of assertion of a distinct identity, culminating in a negotiated settlement — the 16-Point Agreement — that created the state in 1963.

Year	Event
1918	Naga Club formed (Kohima) — early expression of Naga political consciousness
1929	Naga Club submits a memorandum to the Simon Commission asking to be left out of the reformed India
1946	Naga National Council (NNC) formed; A. Z. Phizo becomes a leading figure

1957	Naga Hills–Tuensang Area (NHTA) created (Naga Hills district of Assam + Tuensang) under the Centre
1960	16-Point Agreement between the Naga People's Convention (NPC) and the Government of India — the political basis for statehood
1962	State of Nagaland Act, 1962 passed; 13th Amendment inserts Article 371A
1 Dec 1963	Nagaland becomes the 16th state of India — inaugurated by President S. Radhakrishnan △ verify the inaugurating dignitary
1963	P. Shilu Ao — first Chief Minister; Vishnu Sahay — first Governor △ verify
1975	Shillong Accord (a controversial agreement with a section of the underground)
1997	Ceasefire between the Government of India and NSCN(IM) △ verify year
2015	Framework Agreement signed towards a Naga political settlement △ verify

Memory chain: 1918 Naga Club → 1929 Simon memorandum → 1946 NNC → 1960 16-Point Agreement → 1 Dec 1963 statehood. If you memorise one chain from this file, this is it.

16-Point Agreement — what to know: it was negotiated by the **Naga People's Convention** with the Government of India (1960) and led directly to the creation of Nagaland as a state under the Ministry of External Affairs initially, with Article 371A as its constitutional guarantee. △ verify the specific administrative point about MEA.

3.2 State profile — the fast facts

Item	Value
Statehood	16th state, 1 December 1963
Capital	Kohima
Largest city / commercial hub	Dimapur (also the only railway station & airport of note) △ verify
Legislative Assembly seats	60
Lok Sabha seats	1
Rajya Sabha seats	1
Official language	English
Lingua franca	Nagamese (an Assamese-based creole)
Number of districts	△ verify — the count has grown (16 → 17+ with new districts such as Noklak, Chümoukedima, Niuland, Tseminyu, Shamator, Meluri)
Neighbours	Assam (W), Arunachal Pradesh (N), Manipur (S), Myanmar (E — international border)

3.3 The tribes and their festivals — the highest-value table

Nagaland is officially home to a set of recognised **Naga tribes** (commonly cited as **16–17 major tribes**) △ verify current recognised count. Each has a signature festival. **Festival + tribe + month is classic objective-question material.**

Tribe	Signature festival	Month (approx.) [△] verify exact dates
Angami	Sekrenyi (Phousanyi)	February
Ao	Moatsü	May
Ao	Tsüngremong	August
Sumi (Sema)	Tuluni	July
Sumi	Ahuna	November
Lotha	Tokhü Emong	November
Konyak	Aoleang (Aoleang Monyu)	April
Chakhesang	Sükrün̄ye / Tsükhenye	January
Chang	Naknyülüm	July
Phom	Monyü	April
Zeliang	Mleingi / Hega	—
Khamniungan	Miu / Tsokum	May
Pochury	Yemshe	October
Rengma	Ngada	November
Sangtam	Mongmong	September
Yimchunger (Yimkhiung)	Metümneo	August

These festival names and months are the ones most commonly cited, but spellings and exact dates vary by source and year — hence [△] **verify** on the months. Learn the **tribe ↔ festival pairing** first (that is what is tested); learn the month second.

Distinguishing tribal features (headline associations):

Tribe	Commonly associated with
Konyak	The former head-hunting tradition; the <i>Anghs</i> (hereditary chiefs); facial tattoos of the older generation; Mon district
Angami	Terraced wet-rice cultivation; Kohima region; Sekrenyi
Ao	Among the first to receive Western education & Christianity; Mokokchung
Sumi (Sema)	Zunheboto region
Lotha	Wokha region
Chakhesang	Phek region (a composite: Chokri, Kheza, Sangtam)

3.4 Hornbill Festival — the flagship

Point	Detail
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Nickname	"Festival of Festivals"
When	1–10 December every year
Where	Naga Heritage Village, Kisama, near Kohima
Started	2000 (by the Government of Nagaland to promote inter-tribal culture & tourism)
Named after	the hornbill , a bird revered across Naga folklore
Coincides with	Nagaland Statehood Day (1 December)

MCQ trap: Hornbill Festival is at **Kisama**, not in Kohima town itself; it runs 1–10 December.

3.5 Geography of Nagaland

Feature	Detail
Terrain	Hilly, part of the Naga Hills / Patkai ranges; young fold mountains
Highest peak	Mount Saramati (~3,841 m) [△] verify altitude, on the Myanmar border ; Kiphire district
Dzükou Valley	Famous valley on the Nagaland–Manipur border near Kohima; the Dzükou lily ; trekking
Japfü peak	Second-highest, near Kohima; famous rhododendron trees
Major rivers	Doyang (longest river <i>in</i> Nagaland [△] verify), Dhansiri , Tizu , Zungki , Milak
River drainage	Doyang & Dhansiri drain westward to the Brahmaputra system; Tizu drains eastward to the Chindwin (Myanmar) — a good discriminator fact
Intanki National Park	In Peren district — the state's only national park [△] verify sole-status
Fakim Wildlife Sanctuary	Kiphire district
Other protected areas	Puliebadze WLS, Rangapahar WLS [△] verify
Climate	Monsoon; heavy rainfall; pleasant summers in the hills

3.6 Jhum cultivation (shifting agriculture)

Intuition. *Jhum* is the traditional slash-and-burn farming of the hills: a patch of forest is cleared and burnt, cropped for a couple of years, then left fallow to regrow while the farmer moves on. It is culturally central and ecologically debated.

Point	Detail
Also called	Shifting / slash-and-burn cultivation
Method	Clear forest → burn → sow mixed crops → crop 1–3 years → fallow → move on
Advantages	Suits steep terrain; low input; ash fertilises soil; biodiversity in mixed cropping
Problems	Deforestation, soil erosion, falling yields as fallow cycles shorten with population pressure

Exam angle

Contrast with **terraced wet-rice** (the Angami practise sophisticated terrace irrigation)

3.7 State symbols & notable facts

Symbol	Value  verify all
State animal	Mithun (<i>Bos frontalis</i>) — a semi-domesticated bovine, a marker of wealth
State bird	Blyth's Tragopan
State flower	Rhododendron
State tree	Alder (<i>Alnus nepalensis</i>)

Nagaland notes worth carrying: overwhelmingly **Christian**-majority state; famed for **Naga King Chilli (Bhut Jolokia / Raja Mircha)**, one of the world's hottest chillies, with a **GI tag**  verify; **Naga Tree Tomato** and other GI produce; the **Kohima War Cemetery** commemorates the **Battle of Kohima (1944, WWII)** — "the Stalingrad of the East" — a fixed historical fact worth remembering.

3.8 The other North-East states (basics)

The North-East = the "**Seven Sisters**" + **Sikkim** = **8 states**. Know capital + one fact each; this is common objective material.

State	Capital	One high-yield fact
Assam	Dispur	Largest NE state by population; Kaziranga NP (one-horned rhino); tea; Brahmaputra
Arunachal Pradesh	Itanagar	"Land of the Dawn-lit Mountains"; Tawang monastery; borders China
Manipur	Imphal	Loktak Lake (floating <i>phumdi</i>); Keibul Lamjao (only floating NP; sangai deer); classical dance <i>Manipuri</i>
Meghalaya	Shillong	Cherrapunji/Mawsynram — wettest places; living root bridges; matrilineal society
Mizoram	Aizawl	High literacy; bamboo dance (Cheraw) ; <i>Mautam</i> (bamboo-flowering famine)
Tripura	Agartala	Bordered by Bangladesh on three sides; Ujjayanta Palace
Sikkim	Gangtok	India's first fully organic state ; Kanchenjunga (highest peak in India); 22nd state (1975)

Memory hook for the Seven Sisters: "MMANTA" + Assam = Manipur, Meghalaya, Arunachal, Nagaland, Tripura, Assam, Mizoram. **Sikkim is the "one brother"** added to the seven sisters.

MCQ trap: the capital of Arunachal is **Itanagar** (not Tawang); the capital of Assam is **Dispur** (not Guwahati — Guwahati is the largest city). Sikkim is the **first organic state**; Nagaland is the **16th state**.

Nagaland/NE — likely exam questions

- [5] Trace the path to Nagaland's statehood. (*1918 Naga Club* → *16-Point Agreement* → *1 Dec 1963*.)

- [5] What is jhum cultivation? State two advantages and two problems.
- [5] Write a note on the Hornbill Festival.
- [10] Describe the major tribes of Nagaland and their festivals.
- [5] Name the highest peak, longest river and only national park of Nagaland.
- [10] Give an account of the physical geography of Nagaland.

Nagaland/NE — MCQ traps (with answers)

Answers

1. Nagaland became a state on? → **1 December 1963** (16th state) 2. Article for Nagaland's special provisions? → **371A** 3. "Festival of Festivals"? → **Hornbill Festival** (Kisama, 1–10 Dec) 4. Highest peak of Nagaland? → **Mount Saramati** 5. Only national park in Nagaland? → **Intanki National Park (Peren)** 6. State animal of Nagaland? → **Mithun** 7. Lingua franca of Nagaland? → **Nagamese** 8. Capital of Arunachal Pradesh? → **Itanagar** 9. India's first fully organic state? → **Sikkim** 10. The 16-Point Agreement was signed in? → **1960**

SECTION 4 — INDIAN HISTORY

History is broad but the *tested* facts are a manageable core. Prioritise the **freedom-struggle timeline** (§4.3) — it is the densest scorer.

4.1 Ancient India (headline facts)

Period	Must-know facts
Indus Valley / Harappan (c. 2500–1900 BCE)	Bronze Age; planned cities (Harappa , Mohenjo-daro , Dholavira , Lothal); great bath; drainage; script undeciphered; on the Sindhu (Indus)
Vedic Age (c. 1500–600 BCE)	Aryans; the four Vedas (Rig, Sama, Yajur, Atharva); Rig Veda oldest; caste (varna) system emerges
Buddhism / Jainism (6th c. BCE)	Gautama Buddha (Four Noble Truths, Eightfold Path; enlightenment at Bodh Gaya); Mahavira (24th Tirthankara of Jainism)
Mauryan Empire (322–185 BCE)	Founded by Chandragupta Maurya (guided by Chanakya/Kautilya , <i>Arthashastra</i>); Ashoka — Kalinga War → Buddhism; rock edicts; Sarnath Lion Capital = national emblem
Gupta Empire (c. 320–550 CE)	"Golden Age": Chandragupta II (Vikramaditya) ; Aryabhata (zero, astronomy), Kalidasa ; decimal system

4.2 Medieval India (headline facts)

Period	Must-know facts
Delhi Sultanate (1206–1526)	Five dynasties — Slave, Khilji, Tughlaq, Sayyid, Lodi; Qutb-ud-din Aibak (Qutub Minar); Alauddin Khilji (market reforms)
Vijayanagara & Bahmani	Southern kingdoms; Krishnadevaraya (Vijayanagara)

Mughal Empire (1526–1857)	Babur (won 1st Battle of Panipat, 1526); Akbar (<i>Din-i-Ilahi</i> , Mansabdari); Shah Jahan (Taj Mahal); Aurangzeb (largest extent, then decline)
Marathas	Shivaji — founder of the Maratha empire; guerrilla warfare
Bhakti & Sufi movements	Kabir, Guru Nanak, Mirabai, Chaitanya; devotional, anti-caste, syncretic

4.3 Modern India — the freedom-struggle timeline (learn cold)

Intuition. The exam loves dated events. Learn this as a single spine; hang everything else off it.

Year	Event
1757	Battle of Plassey — British power begins in Bengal
1857	Revolt of 1857 ("First War of Independence"); Mangal Pandey; end of Mughal rule; Crown takes over (1858)
1885	Indian National Congress founded (A. O. Hume; first session Bombay, W. C. Bonnerjee)
1905	Partition of Bengal (Curzon) → Swadeshi Movement
1906	Muslim League founded (Dhaka)
1915	Gandhi returns from South Africa
1919	Jallianwala Bagh massacre (Amritsar, 13 April); Rowlatt Act; Government of India Act 1919 (Montagu–Chelmsford)
1920–22	Non-Cooperation Movement ; called off after Chauri Chaura (1922)
1928	Simon Commission protest; Lala Lajpat Rai injured
1930	Dandi Salt March (12 March) → Civil Disobedience Movement ; Purna Swaraj declared (26 Jan 1930, Lahore session)
1931	Gandhi–Irwin Pact
1935	Government of India Act, 1935 (blueprint for much of the Constitution)
1942	Quit India Movement ("Do or Die"); INA under Subhas Chandra Bose ("Give me blood...")
1946	Cabinet Mission; Constituent Assembly; Naval Mutiny
1947	Independence, 15 August ; Partition

Key figures — one line each: **Gandhi** (non-violence, Satyagraha); **Nehru** (first PM); **Sardar Patel** ("Iron Man", integration of princely states); **Bhagat Singh** (revolutionary, executed 1931); **Subhas Chandra Bose** (INA, Azad Hind); **Ambedkar** (Constitution, social reform); **Tilak** ("Swaraj is my birthright").

4.4 Naga / North-East angle in history

- **Battle of Kohima (1944)** — a decisive WWII battle that helped halt the Japanese advance into India; commemorated at the **Kohima War Cemetery** with the famous

epitaph. Frequently pairs history with Nagaland GK.

- The Naga political timeline (§3.1) can itself be asked as "modern history of the North-East."

History — likely exam questions

- [5] Why is the Revolt of 1857 called the First War of Independence?
- [5] Write a note on the Dandi Salt March.
- [10] Describe the main phases of the Indian freedom struggle from 1919 to 1947.
- [5] What was the significance of the Battle of Kohima (1944)?

History — MCQ traps (with answers)

Answers

1. INC founded in? → **1885** 2. Jallianwala Bagh massacre year & city? → **1919, Amritsar** 3. Quit India Movement year? → **1942** 4. First Battle of Panipat? → **1526 (Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi)** 5. National emblem is adapted from? → **Ashoka's Lion Capital at Sarnath** 6. "Golden Age of India" refers to? → **Gupta period** 7. Who declared "Swaraj is my birthright"? → **Bal Gangadhar Tilak** 8. Salt March started from? → **Sabarmati Ashram to Dandi (1930)**

SECTION 5 — INDIAN ECONOMY

Intuition first. Economics questions in a state GK paper are conceptual and definitional, not quantitative. Know *what each term means* and *which body does what*.

5.1 National income concepts

Term	Plain meaning
GDP (Gross Domestic Product)	Value of all goods & services produced within the country's borders in a year
GNP (Gross National Product)	GDP + net income from abroad (earned by nationals)
NNP (Net National Product)	GNP – depreciation
Per capita income	National income ÷ population
Real vs Nominal	Real GDP is adjusted for inflation; nominal is at current prices

5.2 Inflation

Intuition. Inflation is a **sustained rise in the general price level** — your money buys less over time.

Type	Meaning
Demand-pull	Too much money chasing too few goods
Cost-push	Rising input costs push up prices
Measured by	CPI (Consumer Price Index) and WPI (Wholesale Price Index)

Deflation

General fall in prices; **Disinflation**

5.3 Fiscal vs Monetary policy — a core comparison

Feature	Fiscal policy	Monetary policy
Run by	Government (Ministry of Finance)	RBI (central bank)
Tools	Taxation, government spending, borrowing	Repo rate, CRR, SLR, open-market operations
Presented via	The Union Budget	The Monetary Policy (MPC)
Aim	Growth, redistribution, demand management	Price stability, controlling money supply

Key RBI tools (know the direction): raising the **repo rate** makes borrowing costlier → cools inflation. **CRR** (Cash Reserve Ratio) and **SLR** (Statutory Liquidity Ratio) are the shares of deposits banks must keep in reserve.

5.4 The Union Budget

- Presented by the **Finance Minister**, usually on **1 February**.
- **Article 112** — the "Annual Financial Statement."
- **Revenue Budget** (recurring income/expenditure) vs **Capital Budget** (assets & liabilities). **Fiscal deficit** = total expenditure – total receipts (excluding borrowings).

5.5 Key institutions

Body	Role
RBI (est. 1935)	Central bank; issues currency; controls monetary policy; banker to the government
NITI Aayog (2015)	Policy think-tank; replaced the Planning Commission; "cooperative federalism"
SEBI	Regulates the stock market
Finance Commission	Centre–State tax devolution (Art. 280)

5.6 GST (Goods and Services Tax)

Point	Detail
Introduced	1 July 2017 (101st Amendment, 2016)
Idea	"One Nation, One Tax" — a single indirect tax replacing many (VAT, excise, service tax)
Components	CGST (Centre), SGST (State), IGST (inter-state)
Governed by	The GST Council (chaired by the Union FM)
Nature	A destination-based , multi-stage, value-added tax

5.7 Major government schemes (name → purpose)

Scheme	Purpose
MGNREGA	Guarantees 100 days of wage employment (rural)
PM Jan Dhan Yojana	Financial inclusion — bank accounts for all
Ayushman Bharat (PM-JAY)	Health insurance cover for poor families
Digital India	Digital infrastructure & e-governance
Swachh Bharat Mission	Sanitation, toilets, cleanliness
PM Awas Yojana	Housing for all
Jal Jeevan Mission	Tap water to every rural household
Skill India / Startup India	Skilling & entrepreneurship
Act East Policy	Engagement with Southeast Asia — directly relevant to the NE & Nagaland's Myanmar border

⚠ verify latest outlays/coverage numbers before quoting any figure.

Economy — likely exam questions

- [5] Distinguish between fiscal policy and monetary policy.
- [5] What is GST? Explain CGST, SGST and IGST.
- [5] Differentiate between GDP and GNP.
- [10] Explain the functions of the Reserve Bank of India.

Economy — MCQ traps (with answers)

Answers

1. GDP + net income from abroad = ? → ****GNP**** 2. GST came into force on? → ****1 July 2017**** 3. Repo rate is set by? → ****RBI (Monetary Policy Committee)**** 4. The Union Budget is presented under which article? → ****Article 112**** 5. NITI Aayog replaced? → ****the Planning Commission (2015)**** 6. Monetary policy is controlled by? → ****RBI****, fiscal policy by the ****Government****

SECTION 6 — GEOGRAPHY

6.1 India — physical divisions

Division	Notes
The Himalayas	Young fold mountains in the north; Greater (Himadri), Lesser (Himachal), Shiwaliks ; highest Indian peak Kanchenjunga (Sikkim)
Northern Plains	Fertile Indo-Gangetic-Brahmaputra plains; alluvial soil

Peninsular Plateau	Old, stable; Deccan Plateau; Western & Eastern Ghats
Coastal Plains & Islands	Eastern & Western coasts; Andaman & Nicobar, Lakshadweep
Thar Desert	Rajasthan (arid)

6.2 Rivers

System	Rivers
Himalayan (perennial)	Ganga, Yamuna, Brahmaputra, Indus — snow-fed, perennial
Peninsular (seasonal)	Godavari ("Dakshin Ganga", longest peninsular river), Krishna, Kaveri, Narmada, Tapi (west-flowing into Arabian Sea)
North-East	Brahmaputra (Assam); Nagaland's rivers feed both the Brahmaputra and the Chindwin (see §3.5)

6.3 Climate & soils

- **Climate:** tropical monsoon; the **South-West Monsoon (June–Sept)** delivers most rainfall; retreating (NE) monsoon Oct–Dec brings rain to the SE coast.
- **Major soils:** **Alluvial** (plains, most fertile, most widespread), **Black/Regur** (Deccan, cotton), **Red** (peninsula), **Laterite** (heavy rainfall areas), **Mountain/Forest** (hills, incl. the North-East).

6.4 Resources (headline)

- India is a major producer of **coal** (Jharkhand, Odisha, Chhattisgarh), **iron ore**, **tea** (Assam, West Bengal), and a leading producer of **milk, pulses, jute**.
- The NE is rich in **petroleum & natural gas** (Assam — Digboi, Asia's oldest refinery), forests and biodiversity.

6.5 Nagaland geography

Cross-linked to **§3.5** — Saramati, Dzükou, Doyang/Dhansiri/Tizu, Intanki NP, the Naga Hills, jhum. Know these both as "Nagaland GK" and as "geography."

Geography — likely exam questions

- **[5]** Name the major soil types of India with one crop each.
- **[5]** What is the South-West Monsoon and why is it important?
- **[10]** Describe the major physical divisions of India.

Geography — MCQ traps (with answers)

Answers

1. Longest peninsular river? → **Godavari** 2. Two west-flowing peninsular rivers? → **Narmada and Tapi**
 3. Highest peak in India? → **Kanchenjunga** (Sikkim) 4. Most widespread soil in India? → **Alluvial** 5.
 Asia's oldest oil refinery? → **Digboi (Assam)** 6. Which monsoon brings most of India's rain? → **South-
 West Monsoon**

SECTION 7 — GENERAL SCIENCE

Intuition first for the whole section. State-GK science is class-8-to-10 level: definitions, units, one formula, and everyday applications. Do not over-study; nail the standard facts.

7.1 Physics

Measurement & units (SI):

Quantity	SI unit	Symbol
Length	metre	m
Mass	kilogram	kg
Time	second	s
Electric current	ampere	A
Temperature	kelvin	K
Force	newton	N
Energy / work	joule	J
Power	watt	W
Pressure	pascal	Pa
Frequency	hertz	Hz

Motion (Newton's laws):

- First law (inertia):** a body stays at rest or in uniform motion unless acted on by a force.
- Second law: $F = ma$** (force = mass × acceleration).
- Third law:** every action has an equal and opposite reaction.

Equations of motion: $v = u + at$; $s = ut + \frac{1}{2}at^2$; $v^2 = u^2 + 2as$.

Light: travels at $\sim 3 \times 10^8$ m/s; reflection & refraction; a **convex lens** converges (used for magnifying, in the eye), a **concave lens** diverges (myopia correction); **VIBGYOR** is the spectrum; a prism disperses white light.

Sound: a **longitudinal mechanical wave**; needs a medium (cannot travel in vacuum); speed in air **~ 343 m/s** Δ verify; audible range **20 Hz–20,000 Hz**; **ultrasound** is above 20 kHz.

Electricity: Ohm's Law $V = IR$; $P = VI$; series vs parallel circuits; a fuse protects against overload; AC vs DC.

7.2 Chemistry

Atomic structure: an atom = **protons (+)** and **neutrons** in the nucleus, with **electrons (-)** around it. **Atomic number** = number of protons; **mass number** = protons + neutrons; **isotopes** have the same protons but different neutrons.

Acids, bases & pH:

Point	Detail
Acid	Releases H^+ ; sour; turns blue litmus red ; $pH < 7$
Base/Alkali	Releases OH^- ; bitter, soapy; turns red litmus blue ; $pH > 7$
Neutral	$pH = 7$ (pure water)
Neutralisation	acid + base $\rightarrow$ salt + water

Everyday chemistry: common salt = **NaCl**; baking soda = **NaHCO₃**; washing soda = **Na₂CO₃**; quicklime = **CaO**; the gas that turns lime-water milky = **CO₂**; rusting = iron + oxygen + water $\rightarrow$ hydrated iron oxide.

7.3 Biology

Human body systems (one line each): digestive, respiratory, circulatory (heart pumps blood; **RBCs carry O₂ via haemoglobin**), nervous (brain, spinal cord), skeletal, excretory (kidneys).

Nutrition & vitamins (classic MCQ block):

Vitamin	Deficiency disease	Source
A	Night blindness	Carrots, leafy veg
B1 (thiamine)	Beriberi	Whole grains
B12	Anaemia	Meat, dairy
C (ascorbic acid)	Scurvy	Citrus fruits, amla
D	Rickets (children) / osteomalacia	Sunlight, fish
K	Poor blood clotting	Leafy vegetables

Macronutrients: **carbohydrates** (energy), **proteins** (growth/repair), **fats** (energy store).

Diseases (cause type):

Disease	Caused by
Malaria	Protozoan (Plasmodium) — spread by female Anopheles mosquito
Dengue	Virus — Aedes mosquito
Tuberculosis	Bacterium (<i>Mycobacterium tuberculosis</i>)
Typhoid, Cholera	Bacteria

outward. **"Only son of my mother's father"** = my maternal grandfather's only son = **my maternal uncle** (or father, if worded so — read carefully).

Worked: "Pointing to a man, a woman said, 'His mother is the only daughter of my mother.'" → the only daughter of the woman's mother = the woman herself → so the man's mother = the woman → **the man is her son.**

Practice

1. "A is B's sister. C is B's mother. D is C's father. How is A related to D?" → A is C's daughter → C is D's daughter → ****A is D's granddaughter.**** 2. "If P is the brother of Q, and Q is the sister of R, how is P related to R?" → ****P is R's brother.**** (assuming P is male)

8.4 Direction sense

Shortcut: draw N-up, E-right axes; track each move; net displacement by Pythagoras if asked for distance. Remember at sunrise your shadow falls **west** (sun in east).

Worked: walk 3 km North, then 4 km East. Distance from start = $\sqrt{(3^2 + 4^2)} = \mathbf{5 \text{ km}}$; direction = **North-East.**

Practice

1. Walk 5 km South, turn left, walk 5 km. Which direction do you now face? → started facing S, ****turn left** → East. ****** (Left of South is East.) 2. 6 km East then 8 km North → straight-line distance = $\sqrt{(36+64)} = \mathbf{10 \text{ km.}}$ ******

8.5 Syllogism

Shortcut: use Venn diagrams. "All A are B" = A circle inside B. A conclusion is valid only if it is true in **every** possible diagram.

Worked: *All cats are animals. All animals are living.* → **All cats are living** (valid); "Some living are cats" (valid). "All animals are cats" (invalid).

Practice

1. *All pens are books. Some books are red.* → "Some pens are red"? → ****Invalid**** (not necessarily). "Some books are pens"? → ****Valid**** (conversion of "all pens are books"). 2. *No dog is a cat. All cats are pets.* → "No dog is a pet"? → ****Invalid.**** "Some pets are not dogs"? → ****Valid.****

8.6 Analogy

Shortcut: name the *relationship* in the first pair, then apply it.

Worked: Doctor : Hospital :: Teacher : ? → workplace → **School.**

Practice

1. Hand : Glove :: Foot : ? → ****Sock/Shoe**** 2. Cub : Bear :: Kitten : ? → ****Cat**** 3. India : Rupee :: Japan : ? → ****Yen****

8.7 Ratio & proportion

Shortcut: a ratio a:b can be scaled; if a:b = c:d then **ad = bc** (cross-multiply).

Worked: divide ₹600 between A and B in ratio 2:3 → total parts 5 → one part = 120 →

A = ₹240, B = ₹360.

Practice

1. Divide 750 in ratio 3:2 → parts 5, one part 150 → **450 and 300.** 2. If $4:5 = x:20 \rightarrow x = (4 \times 20)/5 = \textbf{16}.$

8.8 Percentages

Shortcut: $x\%$ of $y = (x/100) \cdot y = \mathbf{x \cdot y / 100}$. To increase by $x\%$, multiply by $(1 + x/100)$. Percentage change = $(\text{change}/\text{original}) \times 100$.

Worked: a shirt costs ₹800, increased 15% → $800 \times 1.15 = \textbf{₹920}$.

Practice

1. 25% of 480 = **120.** 2. A number increased from 200 to 250 → % increase = $(50/200) \times 100 = \textbf{25\%}$. 3. If price falls 20% from ₹500 → $500 \times 0.8 = \textbf{₹400}.$

8.9 Profit & loss

Shortcut: **Profit% = (Profit / Cost Price) × 100** (always on CP unless stated).

$SP = CP \times (1 + \text{profit}\%/100)$.

Worked: CP ₹400, SP ₹500 → profit ₹100 → $\text{profit}\% = 100/400 \times 100 = \textbf{25\%}$.

Practice

1. CP ₹250, SP ₹200 → loss = 50 → $\text{loss}\% = 50/250 \times 100 = \textbf{20\%}$. 2. CP ₹1000, profit 12% → $SP = 1000 \times 1.12 = \textbf{₹1120}.$

8.10 Time & work

Shortcut: if A does a job in n days, A's one-day work = $1/n$. Add rates for people working together.

Worked: A alone 10 days, B alone 15 days → together $1/10 + 1/15 = 3/30 + 2/30 = 5/30 = 1/6 \rightarrow \textbf{6 days}$.

Practice

1. A: 12 days, B: 12 days → together = $1/12 + 1/12 = 1/6 \rightarrow \textbf{6 days}$. 2. A does a job in 20 days; works 5 days then leaves — fraction done = $5/20 = \textbf{1/4}$; $\textbf{3/4}$ remains.

8.11 Time, speed & distance

Shortcut: **Speed = Distance / Time**. To convert **km/h** → **m/s** multiply by **5/18**; **m/s** → **km/h** multiply by **18/5**.

Worked: 72 km/h in m/s = $72 \times 5/18 = \textbf{20 m/s}$.

Practice

1. A car travels 150 km in 3 h → speed = $150/3 = \textbf{50 km/h}$. 2. 36 km/h → m/s = $36 \times 5/18 = \textbf{10 m/s}$. 3. A train 100 m long at 20 m/s crosses a pole in → $100/20 = \textbf{5 s}$.

8.12 Averages

Shortcut: **Average = sum of terms / number of terms.** Average of first n natural numbers = $(n+1)/2$.

Worked: average of 10, 20, 30, 40 = $100/4 = 25$.

Practice

1. Average of 5, 15, 25 = $45/3 = 15$. 2. Average of first 10 natural numbers = $(10+1)/2 = 5.5$.

8.13 Simple & compound interest

Shortcut:

- **SI** = $(P \times R \times T) / 100$.

- **CI:** Amount = $P(1 + R/100)^T$; CI = Amount – P.

Worked (SI): P ₹1000, R 10%, T 2 yr → SI = $1000 \times 10 \times 2 / 100 = ₹200$.

Worked (CI): same, compounded annually → $1000(1.1)^2 = 1000 \times 1.21 = 1210$ → CI = ₹210.

(Note CI > SI by ₹10 — the interest-on-interest.)

Practice

1. SI on ₹2000 at 5% for 3 yr = $2000 \times 5 \times 3 / 100 = ₹300$. 2. CI on ₹5000 at 10% for 2 yr = $5000 \times 1.21 - 5000 = 6050 - 5000 = ₹1050$.

8.14 Probability

Shortcut: **P(event) = favourable outcomes / total outcomes**, between 0 and 1.

Worked: one die → P(even) = $3/6 = 1/2$. One card from 52 → P(king) = $4/52 = 1/13$.

Practice

1. Toss a coin → P(head) = $1/2$. 2. A bag has 3 red, 2 blue balls → P(red) = $3/5$. 3. One die → P(number > 4) = $\{5,6\} = 2/6 = 1/3$.

8.15 Clocks & calendars

Clocks — shortcut: the minute hand gains **5.5° per minute** over the hour hand; each hour mark is **30°** apart; hands overlap **11 times in 12 hours** (every ~65.45 min).

Worked: angle between hands at 3:00 → the hour hand at 3, minute at 12 → $3 \times 30^\circ = 90^\circ$.

Calendars — shortcut (odd days): each ordinary year has **1 odd day**, a leap year **2**; a **leap year** is divisible by 4 (century years must be divisible by 400). Use odd days to jump weekdays.

Worked: what day is 15 Aug next year if this 15 Aug is a Friday and next year is ordinary? → +1 odd day → **Saturday**.

Practice

1. Angle between hands at 6:00 → $6 \times 30 = 180^\circ$. 2. Is 2000 a leap year? → divisible by 400 → **Yes**. Is 1900? → not by 400 → **No**. 3. If today is Monday, what day after 15 days? → $15 \bmod 7 = 1$ → **Tuesday**.

Mental ability — MCQ traps to remember

- km/h → m/s is **×5/18** (not ×18/5). This is the most common conversion error.
- Profit/loss % is **always on Cost Price** unless the question says otherwise.
- In syllogisms, "some A are B" does **not** imply "some A are not B."
- A century year is a leap year **only if divisible by 400** (2000 yes, 1900 no).

SECTION 9 — CURRENT AFFAIRS (Sept 2025 → Sept 2026)

⚠ **This file has NO live-news access and will not invent events, names, dates or statistics.** Fabricated current affairs is the fastest way to lose credibility in an answer. Instead, this section is a **structured "what to look up" checklist** plus a **revision routine** and **reliable sources**. Fill it in yourself from real sources in the run-up to 26 September.

9.1 How current affairs is actually tested

In a state GK paper, current affairs is a small block of **objective recall** — "who won X", "which summit was held where", "which scheme was launched" — plus the odd short note. You do **not** need deep analysis. You need a curated list of the last ~12 months' headline facts, especially anything touching **Nagaland, the North-East, and India's big national events**.

9.2 The categories to track (build a one-line fact for each)

Category	What to capture (Sept 2025 → Sept 2026)
Nagaland state	New CM/Governor/ministers if changed; new districts; state budget highlights; Hornbill 2025 theme/ partner country; major state schemes; any Naga peace-process development
North-East	New CMs/Governors in NE states; NEC/DoNER announcements; major infrastructure (rail to state capitals, highways, airports); Act East developments
National polity	Any new President/VP/PM changes (unlikely mid-term but verify); Chief Justice of India; new laws/ bills passed; election results (any state assembly polls)
International	Major summits India hosted/attended (G20, BRICS, SCO, QUAD, UN); India's bilateral headlines; new heads of major bodies (UN, IMF, World Bank) ⚠ verify
Economy	Union Budget 2026–27 highlights; RBI repo-rate changes; GDP growth print; new economic schemes
Science & tech	ISRO missions & launches; DRDO tests; major discoveries; Nobel-type prizes ⚠ verify
Sports	Major tournament winners (cricket series, Olympics/Asian Games cycles as applicable), Indian medal highlights ⚠ verify
Awards & persons	Bharat Ratna / Padma awards; Jnanpith; deaths of eminent persons; new appointments (Election Commissioners, CDS, service chiefs)

Books & reports	Major indices where India's rank is cited (HDI, Ease of Doing Business successor, Hunger Index) △ verify — memorise India's rank only from a fresh source
Days & themes	The year's UN/national theme days if a source lists them

9.3 Reliable sources (use these, not social media)

Source	Use it for
The Hindu / Indian Express editorials	National affairs + doubles as précis practice
Nagaland Post / Morung Express / Eastern Mirror	Nagaland & NE news — your differentiator
PIB (Press Information Bureau) press releases	Official scheme launches, appointments (authoritative)
PRS Legislative Research	Bills and laws passed
A single monthly current-affairs compilation (a reputable competitive-exam magazine/PDF)	One consolidated monthly recap — pick ONE and stick to it
RBI / Ministry of Finance site	Budget & monetary-policy facts

Rule: trust **PIB and the primary institution's own website** over any secondary summary for a date, a name or a number. If two sources disagree, do not use the fact in the exam.

9.4 The revision routine (do this daily/weekly)

- Daily (15 min):** read one newspaper's front page + the NE page. Jot **one line per item** in a running "current-affairs diary" — date, what, who, where.
- Weekly (30 min):** consolidate the week into a **one-page table** under the §9.2 categories. Star anything Nagaland/NE.
- Monthly (1 hr):** revise the month's one-pagers; self-quiz.
- Last 10 days before 26 Sept:** stop adding new items; **revise your own diary only**. Re-verify every date and name you plan to write.
- Nagaland/NE priority:** because this is your edge, keep a **separate half-page** of Nagaland-only current affairs and over-learn it.

9.5 A blank template to fill in (copy this into your diary)

CURRENT AFFAIRS ONE-PAGER — Month: _____

Nagaland: 1) _____ 2) _____ 3) _____

North-East: 1) _____ 2) _____

National: 1) _____ 2) _____ 3) _____

International: 1) _____ 2) _____

Economy/Budget: 1) _____ 2) _____

Sci/Tech/ISRO: 1) _____

Sports: 1) _____

Awards/Persons: 1) _____

Final revision map — the last week before 26 September

Priority	Study block	Why
1 (do first, do most)	Article 371A + Nagaland/NE (Sections 2, 3)	Highest yield, least-contested, your edge
2	Polity (Section 1)	Most reliable fixed-fact scorer
3	Mental ability (Section 8)	Speed marks; drill, don't read
4	Freedom-struggle timeline (Section 4.3)	Densest history scorer
5	Economy + Science standard facts (Sections 5, 7)	Definitional, quick
6	Your current-affairs diary (Section 9)	Revise your own notes only

One-line summary: GK is 50 fixed marks where knowing beats guessing. Your unfair advantage is **Nagaland GK and Article 371A** — over-learn Sections 2 and 3, lock down Polity and the freedom-struggle timeline, keep mental-ability methods sharp by drilling, and build a verified current-affairs diary from real sources. Never write a "△ verify" number you have not re-checked.